By leveraging React's built-in support for stylesheet preloading and precedence management, developers can ensure optimal performance while maintaining clean and organized codebases.

For this topic, are you able to answer these follow-up/probing questions?

- "When would you choose CSS Modules over styled-components, and vice versa?"
- "What are the drawbacks of using inline styles exclusively, and how do you mitigate them?"
- "In a collaborative environment, how would you ensure CSS consistency and avoid naming conflicts among team members?"
- "How do you handle performance concerns when using multiple stylesheet imports in a large React application?"
- "How does preloading stylesheets impact user experience?"

Initial question: "How does the CSS box model work?"

Analysis: This question assesses a candidate’s understanding of the CSS box model, including its components and how it affects layout. Candidates should be able to explain best practices and recognize exceptions where alternative approaches may be necessary.

Answer: The CSS box model defines how the dimensions and spacing of every HTML element are calculated. Each element is wrapped in a box consisting of four parts, shown in figure 2.6:

- *Content* is the innermost area of an element, where text or images are displayed.
- *Padding* is the transparent space that surrounds the content, located inside the border.
- The *border* is the line that wraps around both the padding and the content.
- *Margin* is the transparent space outside the border, separating the element from other elements.

Figure 2.6 CSS box model, where the content box is at the center, surrounded by padding. The border wraps around the padding, and the margin forms the outermost layer, creating space between elements.